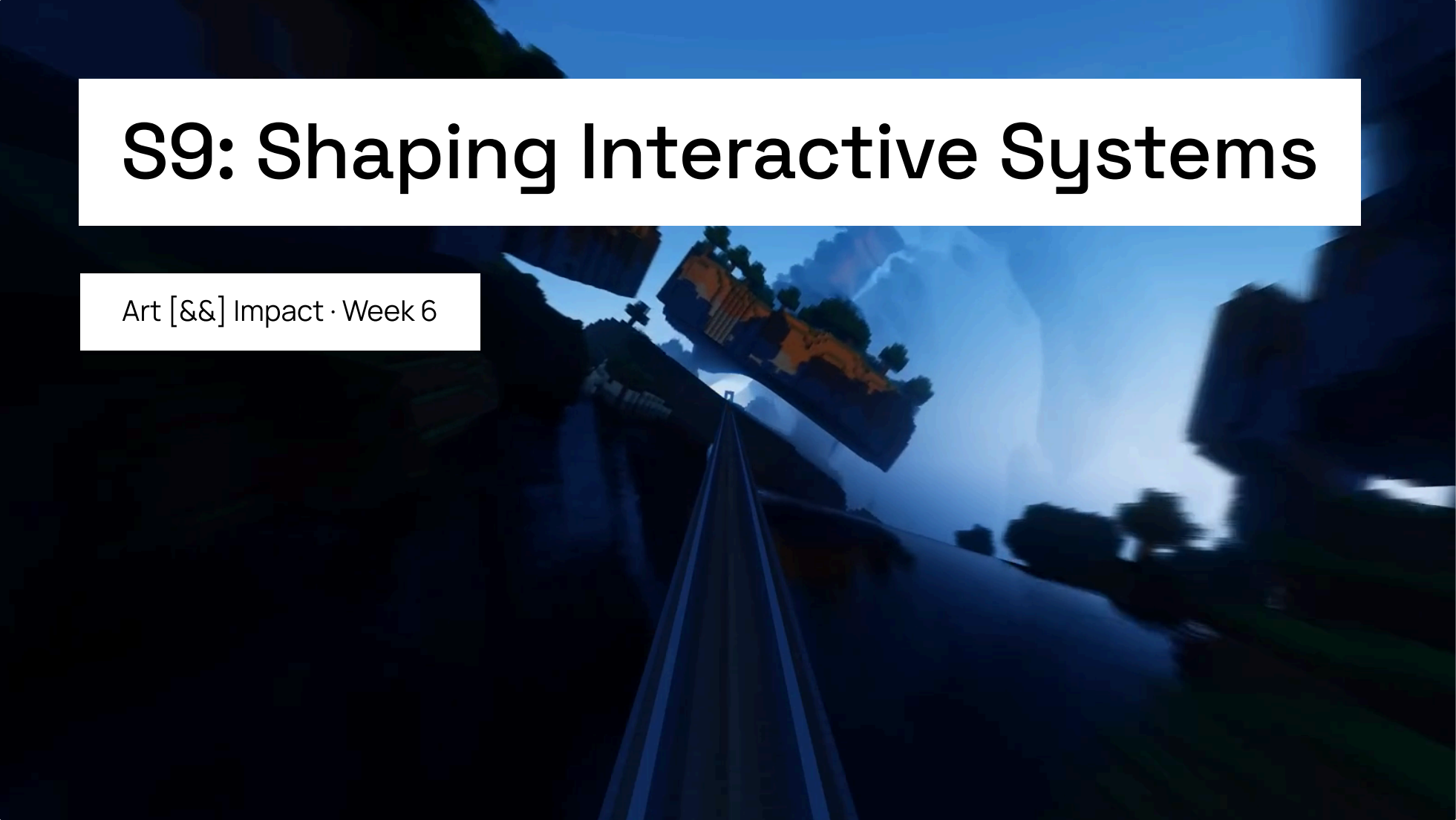


S9: Shaping Interactive Systems

Art [&&] Impact · Week 6



In This Session

BLOCK	CONTENT	DURATION	AI ZONE
Lecture	The Experience Specification	15 min	● No AI
Lecture	Track Focus: Orientation & Fit	15 min	● No AI
Logistics	Space and Equipment	20 min	● Brain-first
Survey	In-Module Survey	5 min	● No AI
Activity	Prepare experience specification for tomorrow	30 min	● Brain-first

Tomorrow in S10: Concept prototyping with silent observation trial.

Where We Are

← LAST WEEK (S8)

Evaluating Experiences

+ UX Trial #1

Evaluating experience · Reading the response · From trial to insight

First UX trial completed

 TODAY (S9)

Interactive Systems

Specify the interaction · Track focus ·
Know what you're working with

Between UX Trial #1 and #2

→ TOMORROW (S10)

Mid-Process Review Workshop

Silent peer observation trial · Concept coherence check

Prepare something testable!

 **It's getting more concrete!** For tomorrow you should know what you're promising in terms of audience interaction, what technical challenges you'll be dealing with, and what you're actually working with.

Experience Specification

What experience your work 'promises' to the audience

The Experience Specification

THE PROMISE

Every **interactive** installation makes a contract with its audience: *"if you do this, something will happen."*

Keeping that promise is both **an artistic decision, and a technical one.**

A broken contract? A system that does not do what it implied it would (unless this is, in itself, the statement it wants to convey through *intentional* design!)

SPECIFY CLEARLY

What does the system do?

What does the audience do?

What changes as a result?

Answering these three questions means being explicit about what you control — and what you leave open to the audience.

Are you currently able to answer all three?

Think It Through

WHAT DOES THE **SYSTEM** DO?

Use your **artistic statement** as anchor! What does the system *need* to do to say what you want to say?

Is what the system does original/surprising or an obvious idea? Not always an issue, but can reduce engagement.

WHAT DOES THE **AUDIENCE** DO?

Think from the perspective of others: does the action you're asking of the audience vibe with your concept?

An interaction that surprises even yourself in some way is a signal you're onto something.

WHAT **CHANGES** AS A RESULT?

What is your artistic **intent**: what should change in the audience — a feeling, a question, a shift in how they see something?

"They experienced something" is like *"and there will be a puzzle"* — it names the hardest part as something to be figured out later

***Creative sobriety check:** would the answers come immediately come to mind to everyone? What, specifically, makes yours different?*

Risks for your Experience Specification

OVER-COMPLEXITY

Too much happening at once — the system overwhelms its own concept. If you can't easily describe the experience specification, it may be trying to do too much.

Simplify to the essential promise.

INTERACTION DEAD ZONES

The audience does something. Nothing responds. Most common failure — and the most immediately felt. Test the full interaction space, not just the designed sequence.

Not easily testable yet, but soon!

Track Focus

Use your track to orient your attention
— and check if a different track fits better!

Your Spec, Through Your Track

CODE & VISUALS

Where this spec tends to break

What changes as a result?

Visual systems can generate engagement easily — that's not the hard part. But does the response *mean* something?

"The visuals react to motion" is a technical answer. *"The audience sees their presence accumulated over time"* is a spec answer.

For S10: Have a working trigger → response loop, however rough. Observers need to do the action and see something happen. Does the response read as meaningful?

REAL-TIME 3D

Where this spec tends to break:

What does the audience do?

A 3D space is immersive — but immersive is not the same as meaningfully interactive.

What specifically does the space *ask* of them? What action produces what consequence?

For S10: Define an active moment in your space — the thing the audience does that matters. Even a rough version is enough. Is it clear to someone new that that moment exists?

Does your spec answer feel like it belongs to your track — or could it fit another one better?

Your Spec, Through Your Track

PROJECTION & AV

Where the spec tends to break:

What does the system do?

Projection is easy to describe as decoration but harder as interaction. Does removing the projection change what the audience *does* — or only what they see?

For S10: Bring a screen-based projector simulation: a video, a looping sketch, anything that shows what the projection *does* in response to the audience.

PHYSICAL + DIGITAL

Where the spec tends to break:

What changes as a result?

The physical → digital loop can feel complete when it's just a trigger-response: “you touch it and it reacts.” But what shifts — in understanding, perception, feeling — as a result?

For S10: Test the physical action! The digital response can be rough. The affordance needs to be understandable without explanation. And do people engage further, explore variations, or move on?

Logistics

Space, equipment, and the things that break your specification

What We're Working With

MAIN ROOM — DARK INSTALLATIONS

~120 m² · shared space · gets quite dark

Power: regular outlets, 3600W combined · extension cords provided but power use must be communicated!

Wifi: confirmed

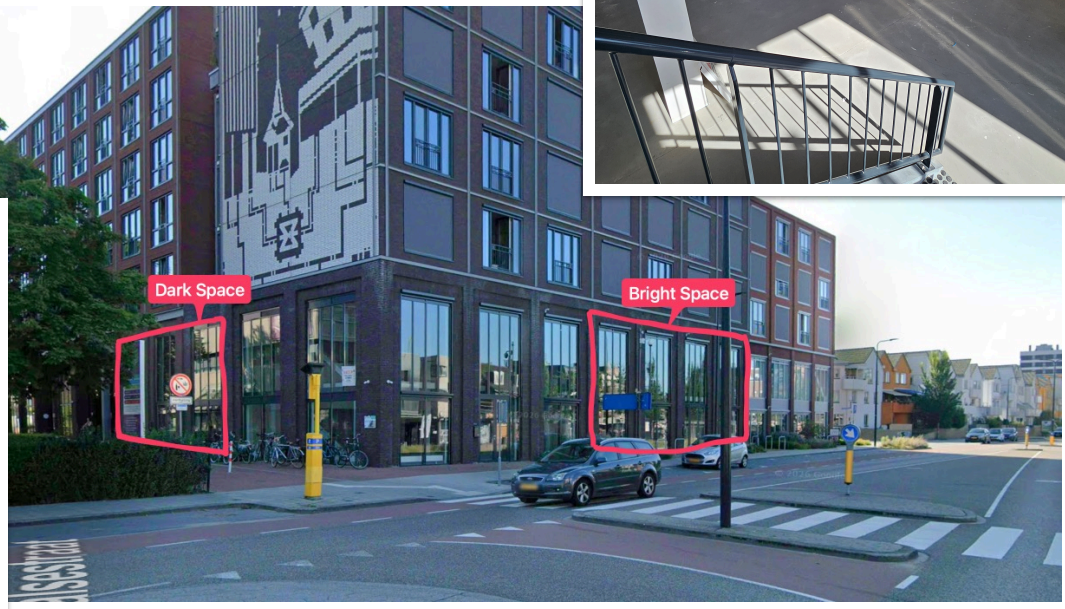
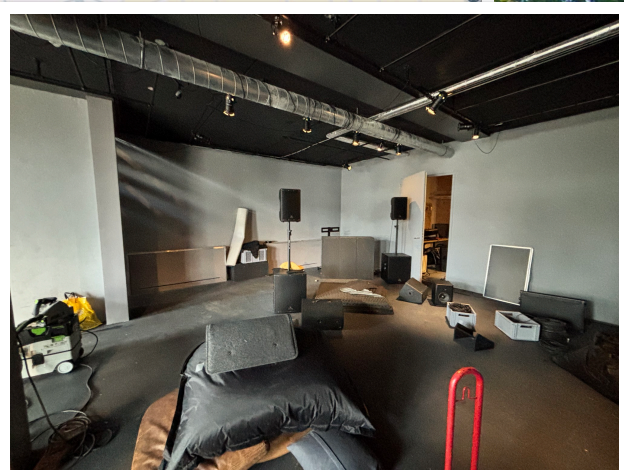
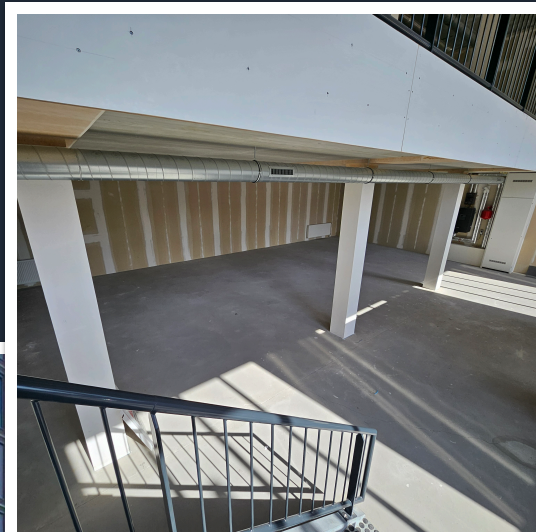
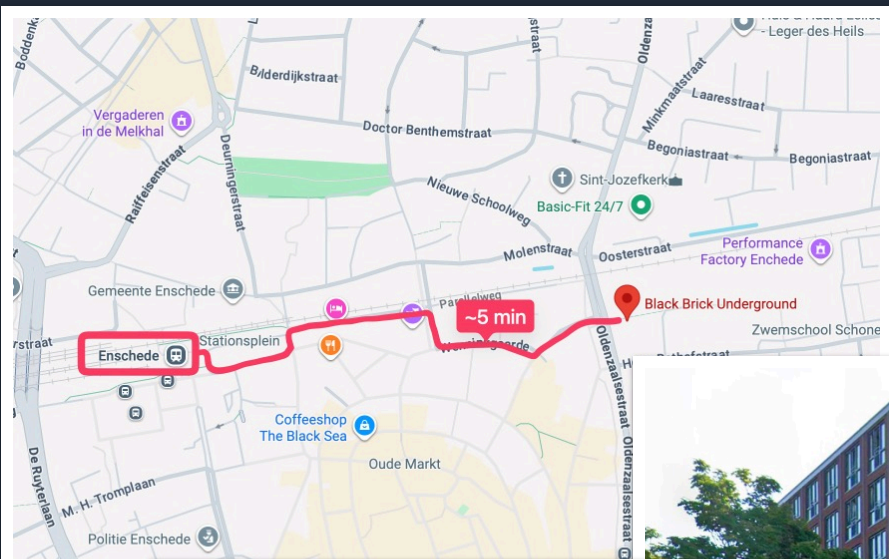
SECOND SPACE — LIGHT INSTALLATIONS

~120 m² · shared space · ambient light (gets warm!)

Power: regular outlets, 3600W combined · extension cords provided but power use must be communicated!

Wifi: to be confirmed — design for offline (or mobile data)

- **Both rooms are shared!** You build your own separation (but we have some materials for this also).
- **Space is not simply divided by groups!** The strength of your statement and UX trials is part of your argument for what is needed!
- Equipment can be borrowed from the **UT Interaction Lab**. Transport from DesignLab to BlackBrick and other shared logistics: coordinate via the **class MS Teams channel**.



Start Your Equipment List

⚠ This is an on-going action item! Start thinking about this.

INSTALLATION NEEDS

- Estimated power draw (roughly)
- Internet: yes / no / offline fallback?
- Noise: silent / ambient / loud
- Dark space or light space?
- ... what else?

WHAT YOU ALREADY HAVE

- Own hardware (laptops, cameras, controllers, etc.)
- Own materials (physical, printed, fabric, etc.)
- Anything already sourced or borrowed

WHAT YOU STILL NEED TO FIND

- Equipment to borrow from the Interaction Lab
- Shared class resources – flag in Teams
- Transport: DesignLab → BlackBrick

Tomorrow in S10

Mid-Process Review Workshop · Week 6 · Friday

What to Bring to S10

EXPERIENCE SPECIFICATION

Written out.

What does the system do?

What does the audience do?

What changes?

You'll need this before you ask for support or using AI. Brain-first rule!

A RUNNABLE PROTOTYPE

Even partial. You'll need something that can be interacted with.

If nothing runs yet: bring your clearest articulation of the experience specification, and which of the three questions you're most stuck on!

In-Module Survey



Please take **5 minutes now** to fill in a brief survey about your experience with this module so far.

2. For M4 in general, so far ... *

	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
The module feels well-organized	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
All necessary learning facilities are available (timetable, manuals, slides, exercises)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have enough time to focus on my deadlines	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
The connection between courses is clear to me	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I get sufficient support from my teachers	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

4. I like the atmosphere (e.g. assignments, lectures, teachers) of ... *

	Not taking the course	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
Art (&&) Impact	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Design for Experience	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Algorithms	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Statistics	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

6. What do you struggle with in this module? *

Enter your answer

7. What do you like about the module? *

Enter your answer

Prepare Experience Specification and Prototype for Tomorrow

● Brain-first

🕒 30min – until end of session

Art [88] Impact

See you at S10 — tomorrow, Friday!